

[LOGIN](#)[TRENDING](#)[REVIEWS](#)[FEATURES](#)[DOWNLOADS](#)[THE](#)[TECH](#)[PRODUCT](#)[FORUM](#)[AI](#)[INDUSTRY](#)[TEXAS](#)[DATA CENTER](#)[BEST](#)[DB](#)[FINDER](#)

Texas hits pause on 1,800 data center projects to scrutinize power and water demands

Combined, the stalled applications would require 474 gigawatts – far above the Texas grid operator's peak demand

By [Skye Jacobs](#) Today 5:19 PM | 19 | [Add TS](#)



Serving tech enthusiasts for over 25 years. TechSpot means tech analysis and advice you can trust.

WHAT JUST HAPPENED? Texas has put a hold on new data center approvals that require access to the state's grid, a move that could



applicants, a move that could stall a large backlog of projects seeking to connect.

The state wants more information before granting access. Abbott said applicants must provide tax break details, power use and generation data, water use and cooling plans, steps to reduce community impact, and facility ownership information. Any project missing that information will not be allowed onto the grid.

"Our top priority is to protect Texans' safety and quality of life," Abbott wrote. "Any project that fails to comply with the requirements set forth by the PUCT (Public Utility Commission of Texas) and ERCOT (Electric Reliability Council of Texas), and by state law, must be denied connection to the Texas grid. Simply put, Texans must come first."

The review appears to follow a PUCT survey that most companies ignored. The agency said it asked 377 data center firms for information on water and power use, but only 28 responded.

The order isn't a statewide ban, but it still affects a major chunk of the projects in ERCOT's queue. More than 1,800 projects are waiting for

[LOGIN](#)[TRENDING](#)[REVIEWS](#)[FEATURES](#)[DOWNLOADS](#)[THE](#)[TECH](#)[PRODUCT](#)[FORUM](#)

above ERCOT's current peak demand.

[BEST](#)[DB](#)[FINDER](#)

Even so, the directive does not hit every project in Texas. Data centers outside ERCOT's territory, including those in El Paso, are not covered. Projects that bring their own power are exempt too, since they don't need to connect to the grid.

The move drew criticism from opponents pushing for the legislature to step in with stricter rules. Texas Agriculture Commissioner Sid Miller called the directive "all hat and no cattle" on the Texas Department of Agriculture's official Facebook page, saying, "Texans need laws with teeth, not another press release designed to make it look like something is being done while hyperscale projects continue moving forward."

// RELATED STORIES

- [AI data centers are delaying Texas housing projects by hiring away electricians](#)



State Rep. Gina Hinojosa, who is challenging Abbott in the 2026 governor's race, dismissed the move as too little, too late. She said Abbott has spent months promoting Texas as a friendly place for data centers, and argued his new pause wouldn't convince anyone the state is suddenly cracking down.

The Texas move is narrower than New York's statewide data center moratorium, but it still adds a major hurdle for developers. For an industry built around fast buildouts and heavy power demand, the pause could have immediate effects.

19 comments

306 likes and shares

See more TechSpot in Google

Add us as a preferred source and our reporting shows up first when you search.



ADD TECHSPOT

Featured Today on TechSpot

Essential Apps to Install on Windows and macOS



LOGIN

TRENDING

REVIEWS

FEATURES

DOWNLOADS

THE

TECH

PRODUCT

FORUM

BEST

DB

FINDER

Police departments are told to call license plate readers
"county resources"

Anthropic AI went rogue and tried to deceive developers into
approving malicious code

Michael Dell's son wants to put battery storage in every
backyard



LOGIN

TRENDING

REVIEWS

FEATURES

DOWNLOADS

THE

TECH

PRODUCT

FORUMS

BEST

DB

FINDER

The best 4K gaming monitors: OLED leads, LCD fights back

User Comments: 19

 Got something to say? Join the discussion.

Load all comments...

DISCUSS

29

Der8auer tests PC chimney effect, dropping CPU temps by 19°C with a 110cm 3D-printed tower

12

Lawsuit claims Micron's \$100 billion New York chip fab could discharge "forever



LOGIN

TRENDING

REVIEWS

FEATURES

DOWNLOADS

THE

TECH

PRODUCT

FORUMS

BEST

Dozens of police officers accused of using license plate cameras to track women

17

This free font can trick AI scrapers into swallowing gibberish instead of your content

10

Anthropic AI went rogue during a cyber test and tried to deceive real developers into approving malicious code

[See more commented news stories](#)

Join the conversation

Create a free TechSpot account to comment and connect with fellow tech enthusiasts.

[Sign up for free](#) – it takes 30 seconds.

Already have an account? [Login](#).

Popular Features

Was Ray Tracing a Scam?

We Test Every Ryzen X3D CPU

How Apple Pay Works



TechSpot PC Buying Guide

BEST

DB

FINDER

The Best CPUs: Gaming & Productivity

Essential Apps for Windows and Mac

[About](#) [Ethics Statement](#) [Terms of Use](#) [Privacy Policy](#)

TECHSPOT : Tech Enthusiasts, Power Users, Gamers

TechSpot is a registered trademark and may not be used by third parties without express written permission.

TechSpot is represented by Future PLC. [Learn about advertising opportunities.](#)

© 1998 - 2026 TechSpot, Inc. All Rights Reserved.